

FOR Codes, Scopus subjects and OpenAlex topics

this is true. A FOR has a code and a name. FOR codes are nested - the first 2 digits are the division and the 4 digits are the group. There is also a 6 digit code called the field that is not used in this project. There is a 2008 and a 2020 version of the FOR. The only place that the 2008 appear are FOR codes in grants awarded prior to the use of the 2020 FOR. There is a pre-created table of 2008 FOR to 2020 FOR that is applied when the ARC data is first extracted. Openalex topics are a hierarchy, domain, field, subfield and topic. This is not encoded in a string but only at JSON level. The subfield level is deliberately mapped to the 254 Scopus minor subjects/subcategories/subfields, which are nested beneath 4 supergroups equal to OAX domains, and 27 subjects/categories/fields equal to OAX fields. OAX fields do not include the multidisciplinary categories of Scopus - this difference relates to journal level and paper level topic coding. There is a bidirectional 1:1 mapping of FOR divisions to Scopus/OAX fields and of FOR groups to Scopus/OAX subfields.

comment on the use of for in splink deduplication of ARC data. i know that a physicist might use a physics or engineering code and there are a lot of cases like this so FOR code is not a strong selector. It is not clear whether levenshtein distance is a reliable measure at all. on the other hand codes can be useful - a physicist/engineer and a chemist/engineer with the same name form might be separated by the FOR they use. however there may be no cases of this. we know that there are only around 10% of grants with >1 org and that is powerful. within an org, even a large one, it should be possible to delineate people with unresolved name forms as a finite set that may be small. This can all happen without splink. splink could resolve the unresolved cases. this would probably mean that a lot of current post-processing could be used more powerfully as pre-splink processing. I am not sure whether it helps but there might then be a very large training set of resolved cases for splink to consume. comment